



This view is sometimes called hedonism:

Suppose that this is true. Then how do we tell whether one outcome is better than another?

Here is a very natural answer. We ‘add up’ the pleasure, and ‘subtract out’ the pain.

Whatever situation has the highest ‘net pleasure’ is the best. This gives us the following view:

# Hedonism

Pleasure is the only good and  
pain is the only bad.

# Utilitarianism

An action is the right thing to do in certain circumstances if, of all the actions available in those circumstances, it would produce the highest net pleasure.

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